

Tequila Sunrise

The agave-based spirit is the latest 'it' drink as more and more Indians take to sipping it

BY SMITA TRIPATHI

M

Move over gin; there is a new kid on the block, and it is creating waves at bars all over India. We are, of course, talking about tequila. Consider this: Last year, about 123,000 cases of tequila were sold in the country, up from around 68,000 cases in 2022. This is a significant increase from the pre-pandemic times in 2019, when 38,950 cases were sold. Considering these trends and prevailing consumer preferences, the market for tequila in India is

expected to grow at a compound annual rate of 12.69% from 2024 to 2032, according to the *India Tequila Market Report 2023*. It projects the value of tequila consumption to surpass ₹2,000 crore by 2028. This surge will be fuelled by global drinking trends and the rising popularity of premium and craft tequila brands, the report says.

A recent report by International Wine and Spirits Research (IWSR) also highlights that tequila is becoming a preferred choice among the urban youth and middle-aged consumers in metropolitan areas, driven by a burgeoning cocktail culture and the perception of tequila as a sophisticated and health-conscious option.

While the global beverage alcohol market struggled—it was up 1% by volumes in 2023, India enjoyed a 5% growth. During the year, spirits sales in India grew 12%, beer demand was up 38%, wine sales increased 19%, and RTDs (ready to drink) experienced a 40% growth, according to the IWSR report. But it